

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

SPIRITUAL RECOURSE

When Delhi chief minister Arvind Kejriwal tweeted his respects for the 15th century Vaishnavite saint Srimanta Sankardev on August 29, he became the first non-Assam CM to do so. More than any spiritual turn, the AAP supremo has been trying to build a base for the party in the state where he perceives an Opposition vacuum. The BJP may be in power, but most of its current stalwarts in the state are ex-Congressmen. Given its 40 per cent Muslim population, the BJP needs the Opposition vote to be split to survive in Assam. Hence Kejriwal and his deputy Manish Sisodia's frequent barbs at Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma. Kejriwal took to Twitter to berate Sarma over the state of education in Assam, while Sisodia, who had accused Sarma of corruption, has to appear in a Guwahati court after Sarma filed a defamation case.

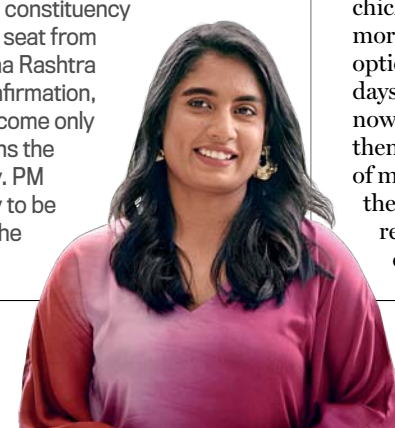
A Festive Touch



Union home minister **Amit Shah** had refrained from visiting Mumbai ever since Uddhav Thackeray became chief minister in November 2019, perhaps because Thackeray's accusation that he had betrayed his promise of power-sharing left him uneasy. That has changed with the change of guard in Maharashtra. Shah is scheduled to visit Mumbai on September 5 to attend Ganeshotsav, organised by his favourite, Ashish Shelar, also the Mumbai BJP president. Seeking Ganesha's blessings when municipal polls are due cannot hurt either.

SECOND INNINGS

Having made a mark in Indian women's cricket, former captain **Mithali Raj** is all set to begin her political innings in Telangana. The 39-year-old met BJP president J.P. Nadda in Hyderabad on August 27 as part of the party's outreach to rope in celebrities. She hopes to get the party ticket from the Secunderabad Cantonment constituency to wrest the seat from the Telangana Rashtra Samithi. Confirmation, though, will come only after she joins the BJP formally. PM Modi is likely to be present on the occasion.



–Kaushik Deka with *Kiran D. Tare, Amarnath K. Menon and Romita Datta*



WELCOME RELIEF

More than three years after he became Andhra Pradesh CM, **Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy** has been exempted by the Telangana High Court from making a personal appearance in the CBI court in Hyderabad. He was required to show up for the trial on the 11 charge-sheets in which he is the prime accused. However, he must appear before the trial court whenever it mandates his presence, the HC ruled, saying they were just allegations against him at this stage. It took 10 years just to frame the charges.





Jailhouse Feast

Mutton is no longer an exception on the prison menu of the Presidency Correctional Home and the Asansol jail, currently home to two Trinamool Congress heavyweights—**Partha Chatterjee** and **Anubrata Mondal**. Both leaders like their meat, and jail superintendents have to regularly tweak the menu to include mutton. Cheaper chicken had hitherto been the more frequent non-vegetarian option, especially on festive days. Other inmates can now thank the VIPs among them. In Asansol jail, 44 kg of mutton was cooked since the jail superintendent was reluctant to serve mutton only to Mondal.